

SPEAKING A2 – TOPIC 4: *BAD WEATHER*

PART 1: INTERVIEW

1. What's your name? Can I see your ID?
2. Where are you from?
3. What's the weather like in your area?
4. How many seasons are there in your country?
5. What's your favorite season of the year?

PART 2: LONG TURN

Describe a time when the weather was bad

You should say:

- *When it happened*
- *What the weather was like*
- *What you did during the bad weather*

and explain how you felt about the bad weather

You will have to talk about the topic for 2 to 3 minutes. You have one minute to think about what you're going to say. You can make some notes to help you if you wish.

PART 3: TWO-WAY DISCUSSION

1. Do you think that the weather affects people's moods?
2. What are some types of bad weather in the world?
3. What can we do to prevent bad weather?

SUGGESTIONS

PART 1: INTERVIEW

⇒ *Suggested answers:*

1. What's your name? Can I see your ID?

My name is Lan. Yes, here's my ID.

2. Where are you from?

I'm from Hanoi, the capital city of Vietnam.

3. What's the weather like in your area?

In my area, the weather is usually hot and humid, especially in the summer. Sometimes there are heavy rains and even sudden storms, which can make travelling difficult.

4. How many seasons are there in your country?

In my country, Vietnam, we usually say there are four seasons in the north: spring, summer, autumn, and winter. But in the south, people often feel there are only two seasons, the dry season and the rainy season.

5. What's your favorite season of the year?

My favorite season is autumn because the weather is cooler and more comfortable. The sky is often clear, and I enjoy walking outside without worrying about heavy rain or extreme heat.

PART 2: LONG TURN

1. Selection

The easiest choice is probably a summer “heat wave” (an unexpected period of unusually hot weather), or a winter “cold snap” (an unexpected period of unusually cold weather).

2. Grammar Point

You can use a mix of tenses:

- *When I was younger the weather used to always be quite predictable.*
- *I had never experienced such extreme temperatures.*
- *I hope I never have to witness these weather conditions again.*

3. Uncommon Vocabulary

Nouns	Meaning	Example
downpour	Mưa như trút nước	<i>We got caught in a sudden downpour on the way home.</i>
shower	Mưa rào ngắn	<i>There will be a few light showers in the afternoon.</i>
typhoon	Bão nhiệt đới	<i>Typhoon Yagi caused serious flooding in northern Vietnam.</i>
flood	Lụt	<i>The flood destroyed many houses in the village.</i>

Nouns	Meaning	Example
landslide	Lở đất	<i>Heavy rain caused a landslide in the mountains.</i>
heatwave	Sóng nhiệt	<i>Last summer, Hanoi suffered a heatwave that lasted for two weeks.</i>
cold snap	Đợt không khí lạnh đột ngột	<i>A cold snap in December made the temperature drop below 10°C.</i>
cold spell	Đợt không khí lạnh	<i>We had a cold spell last winter that lasted for several days.</i>
dry spell	Đợt hạn hán	<i>Farmers lost their crops during the long dry spell.</i>
climate	Khí hậu	<i>Vietnam has a tropical climate with hot, humid summers.</i>
average temperature	Nhiệt độ trung bình	<i>The average temperature in Hanoi in July is about 33°C.</i>

Verbs	Meaning	Example
drizzle	Mưa phùn	<i>It was drizzling when I walked to school this morning.</i>
shift	Thay đổi (hướng, vị trí)	<i>The wind shifted suddenly and blew the roof off.</i>
vary	Thay đổi, biến đổi	<i>Temperatures vary a lot between day and night in the mountains.</i>
pour down	Mưa như đổ	<i>It poured down for three hours non-stop.</i>
soak	Ngâm nước	<i>I was soaked on the way home from school.</i>
suffer	Chịu đựng, chịu thiệt hại	<i>Many farmers suffered when their fields were flooded.</i>
damage	Phá huỷ	<i>The storm damaged hundreds of houses.</i>
evacuate	Sơ tán	<i>People were evacuated from the low-lying areas.</i>

Adjectives	Meaning	Example
unanticipated	Không lường trước được	<i>The unanticipated storm caused serious damage to the city.</i>
unbearable	Khó chịu, không chịu nổi	<i>The heat was unbearable last July.</i>
stormy	Gió mạnh và mưa lớn	<i>The stormy night kept me awake.</i>
torrential [rain]	Mưa xối xả	<i>Torrential rain flooded many streets in just two hours.</i>
foggy	Nhiều sương	<i>It was too foggy to drive safely.</i>
sunny	Nắng, có nhiều ánh nắng	<i>It was a sunny day, perfect for a picnic.</i>
sun-drenched	Ngập tràn ánh nắng	<i>The sun-drenched beach was full of tourists.</i>
severe	Nghiêm trọng	<i>The severe storm caused many problems for the city.</i>
severely hot/cold	Cực kỳ nóng/lạnh	<i>It was severely cold last winter with temperatures below zero.</i>
sweltering	Nóng ngột ngạt	<i>We had to stay indoors during the sweltering afternoon.</i>
balmy	Ấm áp, dễ chịu	<i>We enjoyed a balmy evening by the beach.</i>
chilly	Lạnh se se	<i>It was a chilly morning, so I wore a jacket.</i>
nippy	Lạnh buốt	<i>It felt nippy outside, even though it was only October.</i>
humid	Nóng ẩm	<i>Hanoi summers are very humid.</i>
muggy	Nóng ẩm oi bức	<i>The muggy weather made it hard to sleep at night.</i>
clammy	Ấm ướt, dính nhớp	<i>My shirt felt clammy after walking in the mist.</i>

Idioms	Meaning	Example
out-of-the-blue	Bất chợt	<i>The storm came out of the blue and surprised everyone.</i>
raining cats and dogs	Mưa như trút nước	<i>It was raining cats and dogs when I left work.</i>
Chuck it down	Mưa trút xuống	<i>In spring it usually chuck it down for days on end.</i>
Rain or sunshine	Bất kể thời tiết	<i>Rain or sunshine – I love to be outdoors</i>
Like a sauna	Nóng ẩm như xông hơi	<i>My city is like a sauna in summer.</i>

PART 3: TWO-WAY DISCUSSION

⇒ *Suggested answers*

1. Do you think that the weather affects people's moods?

(Answer) *Yes, definitely, the weather can influence people's feelings.*

(Why) *To be more specific, when it is extremely hot and humid, many people feel tired, stressed, or even angry.*

(Example) *For example, during Hanoi's summer, people often avoid going out because the heat makes them uncomfortable.*

(Opposite) *On the other hand, in autumn, the cool breeze and clear skies usually make people happier and more energetic.*

2. What are some types of bad weather in the world?

(Answer) *In fact, there are many kinds of bad weather such as floods, typhoons, tornadoes, hurricanes, sandstorms, and snowstorms..*

(Why) *These types of weather can be extremely destructive, because they damage houses, destroy crops, and sometimes even take people's lives.*

(Example) *For instance, in September 2024, Typhoon Yagi hit northern Vietnam and brought record rainfall, which led to severe flooding in Hanoi and other provinces, forcing many people to evacuate.*

(Opposite) *On the other hand, some bad weather is not immediately life-threatening, like light storms or heavy rain, but it can still cause inconvenience in daily life.*

3. What can we do to prevent bad weather?

(Answer) *Actually, we cannot completely prevent bad weather, but we can help by planting more trees and reducing traffic emissions.*

(Why) *This is because trees can absorb rainwater and clean the air, while fewer car emissions mean less air pollution and slower climate change.*

(Example) *For example, in big cities like Hanoi, more green parks and fewer motorbikes could reduce flooding and heat.*

(Opposite) *On the other hand, if people keep cutting trees and using too many vehicles, storms and floods will become worse in the future.*